

Rob Higgins

Staff Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Fullstack engineer with 10+ years shipping customer-facing products end to end across frontend, backend APIs, and platform. Tech lead for Snap's AR Enterprise Web SDK after the Vertebrae acquisition; Head of Engineering at Panorama AI for LLM products in React, Node, Python, and PostgreSQL. Mentors engineers, owns multi-quarter delivery, and uses AI tooling as part of day-to-day product work.

EXPERIENCE

Panorama AI · Dec 2023 – Feb 2026 · Santa Monica, CA

Head of Engineering · Oct 2024 – Feb 2026

- Led data and platform teams powering LLM/ML products: Python services, PostgreSQL, JavaScript tags, event ingestion, and architecture standards.
- Owned engineering delivery planning across multi-quarter initiatives: Jira board, project timelines, mentoring, and technical standards for the org.
- Drove product and platform decisions for AI-assisted BI experiences used by customers at scale.

Lead Software Engineer · Dec 2023 – Oct 2024

- Built core infrastructure for predictive recommendations and LLM product experiences.
- Shipped a React widget serving personalized product recommendations to Ashley Homestore shoppers.

Snap Inc. · Jul 2021 – Sep 2023 · Santa Monica, CA

Software Engineer · AR Enterprise Web SDK Tech Lead

- Tech lead for the AR Enterprise Web SDK post-acquisition; owned frontend experiences, backend APIs, merchant integrations, and multi-phase delivery.
- Built the ARES Web SDK (APIs, integrations, event tracking, templating) plus a cross-cloud pub/sub layer connecting Snap and Vertebrae backends.
- Shipped Camera Kit and Three.js web experiences for interactive product exploration and AR try-on.

Vertebrae Inc. · Feb 2016 – Jul 2021 · Santa Monica, CA + Remote

Senior Fullstack Software Engineer

- Early engineer; built the AR/VR e-commerce platform from scratch through the Snap acquisition, shipping React/Node merchant tools used by millions.
- Owned cloud infrastructure with Terraform, Docker, and microservices; built PostgreSQL event pipelines and GitHub Actions CI/CD.
- Drove SDK distribution, ad-tech integrations, and platform architecture decisions supporting the acquisition.

SKILLS

JavaScript / TypeScript · React · Node.js · REST APIs · PostgreSQL · System Design · Microservices · Event-Driven Architecture · Python · AI / LLM · Mentoring · Technical Leadership · AWS / GCP · Docker / Kubernetes · Terraform · CI/CD · SDK & Developer Tools · Data Pipelines / ETL

EDUCATION

Full Sail University · AAS, Recording Arts Technology